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City Weekly
BOSTON SUNDAY GLOBE DECEMBER 29, 2002



Righting past wrongs?

Chinatown, split by highways decades ago, prepares to reconnect after The Big Dig.



(Above), a youngster cycles outside the Chinatown Y in 1958. (Top), the same view today, with a Mass Pike ramp where a building once stood.

By Ric Kahn
GLOBE STAFF

Forty-eight Hudson St., second floor. That's where Caroline Chang grew up. That's where she played kick the can; yapped on her stoop about boys and baseball; watched the noodle man knead his dough with a bamboo stick; greeted neighbors with the traditional Taiwanese "Have you eaten?" — which really meant, "Are you well?"

Then Chang's world fell silent. She had to leave the block. The rowhouses and storefronts on the even side of Hudson Street were demolished, leveled to make way for the westbound ramp of the Massachusetts Turnpike Extension. Instead of seeing friendly faces across the way, those remaining on Hudson Street were left to stare at an ugly wall.



Now, in the spirit of displaced residents like Chang, 62, and her late mother, who did piece work sewing skirts, Chinatown activists are hoping to stitch back together the eastern tip of the neighborhood that was severed 40 years ago by the state highway.

To do so, they are eyeing about an acre of land known as Parcel 24, which sits on the lost end of Hudson Street. It is scheduled to be freed up by late 2004, provided the Central Artery is finally dismantled and diverted underground.

"Reparations!" was the rallying cry at one recent Chinatown meeting. To some, the message was clear: Rebuild the rowhouses! Repatriate the exiles! Regenerate the community!

The activists, who say that 300 Chinatown families lost their homes to Central Artery and Mass. Pike construction in the '50s

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CAMBRIDGE

This month the rabbi turned 90

By Cara Feinberg
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

When Rabbi Moses Holzer — a man who, at 4-foot-9, has been a towering figure in the Cambridge Jewish community — turned 90 years old earlier this month, there wasn't enough room for all the people who wanted to help him celebrate.

"We had to cut off reservations for his party at 200," said Miriam Klapper, the executive director of Temple Beth Shalom (also called the Tremont Street Shul) in Cambridge, where Holzer has presided for the last 45 years. "The outpouring of love for him has been simply unbelievable."

Though Reb Moshe, as his congregation affectionately calls him, hardly thinks of himself as exceptional, even the existence of his temple community testifies to his achievement. What was once a moribund Jewish congregation that could

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Dorchester electricians start close to home on energy savings. **Page 3**

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FYI's Thomas Mulvoy explains where the hills of Trimountain, an early name for Boston, went. **Page 2**

Davis style
Cibeline Sariano realizes a dream in Somerville. **Page 8**



THE CITY WEEKLY 20

Humility leads the list

You don't have to deliver the Democratic National Convention to town to get on this list.

You could bring a Latino touch to Boston's black-and-white world of adult recreational baseball; keep working for an antitobacco committee even after the money for your job was cut; or take in foster infants even while completing difficult grad school courses — and teaching Ivy Leaguers a thing or two about humility.

Sometimes, you could simply persist with steady dignity — mending shoes, cleaning bathrooms, or, in one case, checking coats for high school dances for the past four decades.

These are the people who provide the fabric of a community, and rarely are they recognized.

Not everyone is lovable. Some say Lucas Brunelle and his Critical Mass bicycle group, with noisy, monthly take-back-the-streets ride-alongs, do more harm than good for getting Boston's roadways more bike-friendly. Others salute the efforts of Jonathan Evans and Tim Wienkers to make Boston College serve Fair Trade coffee but wonder how long the movement will last. Others, such as Ken Granderson of roxbury.com and Sister Maria Delaney of South Boston's Notre Dame Education Center, can see their impact every day.

Oh, Tom Menino did make the list — but for a different reason. Brief profiles of the City Weekly 20 are on pages 6-7.

DAVID BEARD
City Weekly editor



GLOBE STAFF PHOTO/MICHELE MCDONALD

"If we had 100 more Sister (Maria) Delaneys," says one Southie resident of the soon-to-depart nun, "the world would be perfect." She makes our list.

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